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Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi, **left**, is greeted by Chinese President Xi Jinping on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) summit in Tianjin, China, yesterday.

Xi, Modi talk friendship in a ‘fluid, chaotic world’

CHINA, INDIA LEADERS PLEDGE DEEPER COOPERATION

TIANJIN, CHINA

Chinese President Xi Jinping and Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi held their first meeting since Donald Trump returned to power, with the long-standing Asian rivals pledging deeper cooperation as they deal with the economic fallout from the US trade war.

Modi announced the resumption of direct flights between the two countries, and said ties in the past year have stabilised after soldiers pulled back from the friction points on the border. The two met at the port city of Tianjin on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit, a security-focused bloc co-founded by China.

‘Right choice’

China and India should not let border issues define their relationship, Xi told Modi, adding that the “right choice” is to be friends. “As long as the two countries remain partners rather than rivals, and see each other as development opportu-

US COURT: MOST TRUMP TARIFFS ILLEGAL

Most of President Donald Trump’s global tariffs were ruled illegal by a federal appeals court that found he exceeded his authority by imposing them through an emergency law, but the judges let the levies stay in place while the case proceeds.

The US Court of Appeals for the Federal Circuit on Friday upheld an earlier ruling by the Court of International Trade that Trump wrongfully invoked the law to hit nations across the globe with steep tariffs. But the appellate judges said the lower court should revisit its decision to block the tariffs for everyone, rather than just the parties in the case.

— Bloomberg

nities rather than threats, China-India relations will flourish and move forward steadily,” Xi was quoted as saying by the Chinese news agency Xinhua.

Modi’s visit, his first to China in seven years, comes as both countries face steep tariffs from Washington and amid growing urgency to diversify global partnerships. Last week, the US followed through with its threat to impose tariffs of 50 per cent on Indian goods.

During the meeting with Modi, Xi said both sides should approach the relationship from “strategic heights and a long-term perspective,” while calling for upholding multilateralism and bringing out “more democracy in international relations,” according to a video of the meeting circulated by the Press Trust of India.

“The international situation is both fluid and chaotic,” Xi said in the video. It is right for China and India “to be friends who have good neighbourly and amicable ties, partners who enable each other’s success, and to have the dragon and the elephant dance together,” he said.

The two leaders also agreed to “expand bilateral trade and investment ties and reduce trade deficit,” according to a statement from India’s Ministry of External Affairs. — Bloomberg

Pakistan approves UAE’s Islamabad airport takeover

Move aligns with nation’s privatisation drive, aiming to improve efficiency

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Senior Assistant Editor

Pakistan has approved a landmark plan for the UAE to assume operational control of Islamabad International Airport, advancing its strategy to outsource management of major state assets through government-to-government (G2G) partnerships.

Officials described the deal as a “strategic pivot” in Pakistan’s broader privatisation and economic reform pro-

gramme, designed to attract foreign capital, modernise infrastructure, and reduce financial losses from underperforming state-owned enterprises.

UAE’s operational expertise

By bringing in UAE’s operational expertise, Pakistan aims to elevate service standards, enhance passenger flows, and unlock the airport’s potential as a regional aviation hub. The move is also expected to improve investor confidence by signalling Islamabad’s commitment to public-private partnerships and economic restructuring.

The deal is viewed as part of Pakistan’s broader effort to deepen its economic relationship with the UAE, a key regional power and major source of investment and remittances.

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UAE solidifies position as global business hub

Multinationals flock to the country, boosting its global business status

ABU DHABI

The UAE has entrenched itself as a major destination for global companies seeking regional or global headquarters. The country’s sophisticated legislative system, advanced digital and financial infrastructure, and strategic geographic location connecting Asia, Africa, and Europe make it highly attractive for multinational firms.

In 2025, major corporations continued to expand in the UAE, strengthening its role as a leading global business platform. Global economic reports highlighted the country’s attractiveness for foreign direct investment, ranking it second among emerging markets in the Kearney Foundation’s “FDI Confidence Index 2025” and among the most competitive countries in the “World Competitiveness Yearbook 2025” by the International Institute for Management Development (IMD).

Global giants

Besides several multinational companies establishing headquarters in or relocating to the UAE in 2025, it also continues to host long-established regional offices of global giants such as Meta, Google, Oracle, Microsoft, Amazon, Cisco, Visa, and Mastercard.

Mohammad Karam, Regional Manager at InSinkErat (Whirlpool), noted that the UAE is a preferred destination for multinational investment, thanks to its dynamic business environment, competitive ad-

ENTRANTS IN 2025

- PayPal:** Opened its regional headquarters in Dubai in April, its first in the Middle East and Africa, serving over 80 markets.
- Veon:** Moved its global headquarters to Dubai, becoming one of the largest global companies headquartered there.
- Partners Group:** Opened a regional office in Abu Dhabi in June.
- Bitcoin.com:** Joined the DMCC Crypto Centre in Dubai.
- Fortress Investment Group:** Established an office in Abu Dhabi to drive its global strategy.

vantages, and flexible policies. He highlighted the country’s strategic platform for innovation, expansion, and long-term partnerships, as well as its commitment to sustainability and a circular economy.

Vinay Surana, Regional CEO for Asia-Pacific, Middle East, and Africa at Allianz Partners, emphasised the UAE’s economic strength and advanced infrastructure. He described the country as offering an integrated environment that values people and innovation while providing multinational companies with significant growth opportunities. Hasan Onder, President of Daikin Middle East, Turkey, and Africa, added that the UAE’s combination of open economic policies, innovation, and advanced infrastructure makes it one of the most attractive global investment destinations.

— WAM



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